Ali Quli refused to go to court personally but he sent his mother along with Ibrahim Khan, most senior Uzbek, to meet with Akbar. An uneasy peace was accepted by all and Ali Quli was warned not to cross the Ganga as long as imperial forces remained in the east. Almost as soon as Akbar left for Benares, however, Ali Quli defied the Padshah and crossed the Ganga. Akbar was furious and turned his army around and headed back for Jaunpur, calling peremptorily for all his noblemen to leave their jagirs and join him there. Munim Khan negotiated a peace once again but it was clear to all that a reckoning would come for the Uzbeks, for Akbar would now never allow them to hold vast areas of lands in jagir as they had done in the past.

At the end of 1566, with Akbar concentrating his forces on the Uzbeks in the east, an unexpected challenge appeared in the north, with the contender being someone who shared the Padshah's blood. Mirza Hakim, youngest son of Humayun, and now thirteen years old, left Kabul and attempted to occupy Lahore. As a Timurid prince Mirza Hakim was no fugitive pretender but a legitimate source of power, able to rally disaffected noblemen to his cause. Indeed, Ali Quli Khan added further heft to the challenge by having the khutba read out in Mirza Hakim's name, thereby proclaiming him a sovereign. Akbar placed Munim Khan in charge of Agra and set off for the north in November 1566. By the time he reached Lahore in February 1567, Mirza Hakim had wisely reconsidered his challenge and retired across the Indus. Akbar now proceeded to demonstrate his power and his might to all those who had claims to rule in Hindustan by organizing a hunt, the enormous, dangerous, and bloody qumargha.

A vast plain outside Lahore was chosen and several thousand foot soldiers, 50,000 according to a history of the time, were assigned to drive birds and beasts from the outlying regions into the centre of the plain, several kilometres in circumference. All the great amirs and courtiers were posted at the outer edges of the field, in their tented encampments, while for a month, deer, cheetahs, hares, leopards, and birds were driven relentlessly into the circle. Every day, and through the cold, watchful nights, entertainments were held at the amirs' tents. Finally, at the end of the month, Akbar mounted his horse and entered the hunting ground. For five days, accompanied only by Aziz Koka, Akbar galloped through the field using the arrow, the spear, the sword, and the musket. The smaller animals he snatched by hand while thundering past on his horse while others he